Dear all the applicants,

Thank you for attending the session on May 14 and May 15. I would like to share the important information you need to use for the AI for Accessibility Hackathon 2024.

1. **The problem statements** – you can select the below problem statements and provide your solutions. You are welcome to create your own problem statement and the solutions.

List of Sample Problem Statements

"Nothing for us without us"

These problem statements have been contributed by Non-Profit organizations working in the field of disability inclusion. Themed around daily life, employment, communication, and accessible education, these problem statements should be viewed as a base for ideation to help trigger thoughtful projects.

CATEGORY: DAILY LIFE
How can AI (artificial intelligence) be used to identify barrier -free routes for wheelchair users using satellite images, open -source maps and other possible image and data sources?
How can we make use of AI to help visually impaired people travel with confidence in the city?
How can AI help the blind travel by themselves, by notifying the accessibility requirements of the public constructions and/o r obstacles on their way, especially those can't be detected by their white cane at the body and head level.
How can AI help create inclusive ATMs (Automated Teller Machines)?
How can AI help visually impaired people use photo editing apps independently?
How can AI help persons with visual impairment safely manipulate cooking appliances and equipment (e.g., gas stove, blender, etc.)?
How can AI provide wearable devices that will help persons with visual impairment traverse the streets independently and safe ly?
How can AI help people with visual impairment in personal grooming (e.g., correct color combination in clothes, hair style th at matches the facial features, etc.)?
How might we automatically create image descriptions in social media for people with visual disabilities?

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CATEGORY: EMPLOYABILITY
How might we use AI to search for and match jobs and training opportunities for persons with disabilities based on their profiles and career aspirations, and informing them of such matches via a user-friendly and accessible platform? How can we further make use of AI to build, update and customize their resumes such that the resumes would be relevant to the jobs that these job seekers are applying to (for e.g., use of industry-specific terms)?
How can AI be used to train persons with disabilities to be proficient in online job interviews (For e.g., video conferencing etiquette and understanding of facial expressions.)?
How can AI create wearable technology to help people with visual impairment navigate their workplaces independently? How can assistive technology for Persons with Disability improve safety and reduce occupational hazards in the workplace?
How can AI provide instantaneous accessibility for remote office applications such as those used for collaboration? How can AI provide accessibility for online applicant assessment tools such as language assessments, verbal reasoning tests, and abstract reasoning tests?

CATEGORY: EDUCATION
For a student with visual impairment, how might we use AI to recognize, organize and describe information accurately in a document that comprises text and graphics that do not have alternate text descriptions and are not arranged sequentially, in a manner that makes sense to the student? Typical screen readers require a certain sequential format of content layout and alternate text descriptions of graphics in order to capture and read out the information accurately.
How might we make online learning more accessible to learners with disabilities, especially from rural communities?

List of Sample Problem Statements
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CATEGORY: COMMUNICATION
How might we use AI to create a better video-conferencing experience for persons with visual impairment (e.g., to "read" facial expressions, identify who's speaking in a video-conference etc.)?
Ahead of meltdowns, many people with autism will show signs of distress. How can we help children with autism to feel calm from emotional distress and be able to reengage with others?
How might we automatically create closed captions for offline use to help the deaf and hard of hearing community?

2. **Judging Criteria – Winning teams will be evaluated on 5 core criteria.**
    1) 30% **Attention to the needs of users with disabilities**: Should demonstrate a deep understanding of the accessibility needs of their users and should be designed to meet those needs in innovative and effective ways.
    2) 25% **Creative solutions**: The projects should demonstrate creative, original thinking and a willingness to take risks in pursuit of making a real difference for users with disabilities.
    3) 15% **Technical proficiency**: Use of Microsoft cloud tech, AI, Cognitive services.
    4) 20% **Real-world impact**: The projects should show potential for real-world impact and demonstrate a clear understanding of challenges, stakeholders, and business models involved in bringing assistive technology solutions to market. Commercial plans for launch and expansion should be included.
    5) 10% **Presentation and communication skills**: The students should be able to effectively communicate their ideas and present their projects in a clear, concise, and engaging way.
3. **Links for the records of May 14-15 and presentations**.
    1) Video Day 1 Session : Day 1 Session.mp4
    2) Video Day 2 Session : Day 2 Session.mp4
    3) Resources : Resources
4. **Key dates**
    1) All the teams must **upload your solutions and business summary** to Upload link within **May 29 before 5pm**.
        i. Click link from AI4A Guide doc
            1. "First name": ใส่ชื่อหัวหน้าทีม
            2. "Last name": ใส่ชื่อทีม
        ii. Your solutions can be in many formats i.e. PowerPoint, Canva, Video.
        iii. The business summary **must be included below information** in Word Document or PDF file format.
            a. Team Name
            b. Team Member
            c. Problem Statement
            d. Solution
    2) **Announce and communicate the final 10 teams for the final presentation round on May 31 at 5pm through your email and call confirmation on Jun3-4.**
        i. Microsoft provides 30-minute Clinic sessions for every 10 team on Jun 6 and Jun 7. Please select the date and time by clicking the link AI4A Hackathon Clinic first come first serve manner
            1. 9:00am
            2. 10:00am
            3. 10:30am
            4. 11:00am
            5. 11:30am

ii. Jun 7, 2024
    1. 1:00pm
    2. 1:30pm
    3. 2:30pm
    4. 3:30am
    5. 4:00am

3) **The final presentation is on Jun 12, 2024,** from 9am – 12:30pm.
    i. Presentation 10 minutes,
    ii. Questions & Answers 5 minutes from the judges.
    First come First serve from the registration at Microsoft on Jun 12, 2024.

Note: If you are in the up countries, please request it through คุณพวงชมพู we will set up Microsoft Teams for the on-line presenting.

Venue: **Microsoft Thailand Limited; Room# MPR 1, MPR 2, MPR 3**

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